Buck Buchanan And Cobras Highlight Reunion Of 'Monday Nite Footballers'

By James Nunnelly

Led by a stimulating address by an ex-Kansas City Chief and All-Pro defensive tackle and a 35-minute, foot-stomping performance by the Marching Cobras, the St. Louis Monday Nite Footballers were entertained by their Kansas City counterparts during the Kansas City Chiefs-St. Louis Cardinals Governor's Cup football weekend.

On Saturday morning, Aug. 31, the guests were escorted o the Roanoke room of the Crown Center hotel. After a traditional breakfast, Buchanan spoke to the group about his life and how football influenced him, especially teaching himto be "on time" and to value teamwork. Several times he praised the personal influence from Eddie Robinson, his football coach at Grambling university and the winningest coach in college football.

Other highlights in Buchanan's speech were:

The Chiefs disappointing championship, overtime loss to Miami on Christmas Day 1971 in Old Municipal Stadium;

The brotherhood of professional athletes, especially his admiration for teammate Otis Taylor, the former All-Pro receiver;

The Chiefs, 1970, Super Bowl victory over Minnesota; and

His feeling that the 1985 Chiefs were the "best team in recent years". He would not predict the number of games the Chiefs would win.

Buchanan was accompanied by his wife Georgia. He currently is doing promotional work for the Miller Brewing Company and has been featured in the award-winning, Miller Lite commercials.

On Saturday afternoon after the brunch, the guests were escorted back to the Ramada Inn Southeast poolside area. There, the Marching Cobras, a nationally-known drill team entertained the guests with a 40-minute, non-stop performance. Several Monday Niters learned some of the Cobra skills.

Other events held in or around the Ramada Inn Hardesty Suite were:

A get acquainted mixer on Friday night;

A presentation of the traveling trophy to the winning group from last years winner. The founders of the Kansas City group received the trophy from Stewart Watson, a founder in both groups. Kansas City founders included Carl Clark, Isaac Gardner Jr., Ollie Hubbard, Oscar Jameson of Cherry Hill, N.J. The Chiefs won the game 17-13;

A 1950's pantomine about the amorous expectations a new, shiny car should bring. The skit was performed by the husband-wife team of Carl and MaryLynn Clark; and

A keepsake-set of matching napkins and matches were presented to each of the guests. The gifts in Crimson and white, the color of the St. Louis Cardinal team, bore the names of each of the guests. Another set of balloon-wrapped gifts awaited the guests on their arrival. This event took place near the rustic, pastoral, scenic area near Benjamin Stables.

Food was prepared by the wives and significant friends. The smorgasbord for the two days included chicken wings, brisket and ham platter, fruit salad, potato salad, tossed salad, baked beans, vegetable plate, cheese balls, chips and dip, egg rolls and a "five alive" punch.

Another unexpected group called "Connoisseur 20/20" joined the postgame party for food and drink.

The groups recognized Georgia Johnson Buchanan for her contribution to the group over the years.

Howard Gipson of the St. Louis group thanked the K.C. Monday Nite Footballers for their hospitality and promised more of the same when the St. Louis group entertained next year. Lloyd McNeill, another St. Louis guest, said the theme should be "No Tricks in 86."

Guests from St. Louis included:

Kathy and Howard Gipson Jr., Lloyd McNeill, Mackie and Reggie Joseph, Chicago, Willa and Jimmie Ray Hubbard (formerly of Kansas City), Louise and Willa Dent, Alvernys and Stewart Watson (formerly of Kansas City) Juanita and Fred Thomas were unable to attend because of family illness.

Other out-of-town guests included Marva Jameson of Cherry Hill, N.J. and Carola and Charles Allen of Columbia, Mo.

Hosts for the festivities were: Bevely and Dr. Charles Allen; Carolyn and Paul Booker; Edna Martin Brannock and Tom Brown; Marylynn and Carl Clark; Vee Maxey and Isac Gardner Jr.; Sandra Inez and Ollie Hubbard; Janice and James Nunnelly; Jerry Price; Celeste and Ed West.

C. Ashley, Faye Jackson and Darnita Price were unable to attend.

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